

# Before & after jar display

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| <b>Category</b>    | Display - Passive engagement - Take-home                                                                                                            |
| <b>Skill level</b> | Grab & go. Zero facilitation required - fresh produce next to its preserved version draws people in on its own.                                     |
| <b>Audience</b>    | All ages. Fresh Willamette Valley produce paired with its preserved form (jam, canned, pickled, frozen, dried), with an info card for each pairing. |
| <b>Setup time</b>  | 10 minutes (arrange the display)                                                                                                                    |

## DESCRIPTION

Fresh produce displayed next to its preserved version - fresh strawberries beside strawberry jam, fresh cucumbers beside pickles, fresh green beans beside canned. Visual and aromatic, it draws people to the table with no facilitation. Each pairing has a 4x6 info card with the method, Willamette Valley season, fresh-to-preserved yield, and a fun fact. 20 pairings; a tablet browser is included. Rotate seasonally to match the market.

## MATERIALS NEEDED

### *Print (the display)*

- The "display-cards.pdf" - a 4x6 info card for each pairing (method, season, yield, fun fact, source). Print on card stock and stand one next to each jar pair.

### *Digital version (tablet)*

- Open the browser: sign in to the MFP Volunteer Resource Hub, tap "Outreach," then "Play on tablet" on the Before & after card. Search or browse the pairings.

### *Both*

- Fresh seasonal produce (bought the day of) and your own preserved jars.
- An attractive display (cutting board, basket, or stand), table and MFP / OSU Extension signage.
- This Activity guide on the table.

## SETUP

1. Pick pairings that match what is at the market this week (rotate seasonally).
2. Set out the fresh produce next to your preserved jars, and stand the matching info card beside each pair.
3. Optional: open the digital browser on a tablet for visitors who want more detail.

## ACTIVITY DIRECTIONS

### *Running it*

1. Let the display draw people in - the natural opener is "what am I looking at?"
2. Point out the fresh-to-preserved pairing, the season, and the yield (how much fresh makes how much preserved).
3. Share the fun fact and invite questions; refer "how do I make this?" to a Master Food Preserver or the tested recipes.

## VOLUNTEER NOTES

- Zero facilitation needed - the display works on its own; the info cards do the talking.
- Rotate pairings to match what is in season at the market that week.
- Buy the fresh produce the day of for the best look and smell.

- Refer "how do I preserve this?" questions to a Master Food Preserver or the tested recipes (Recipe card swap station).